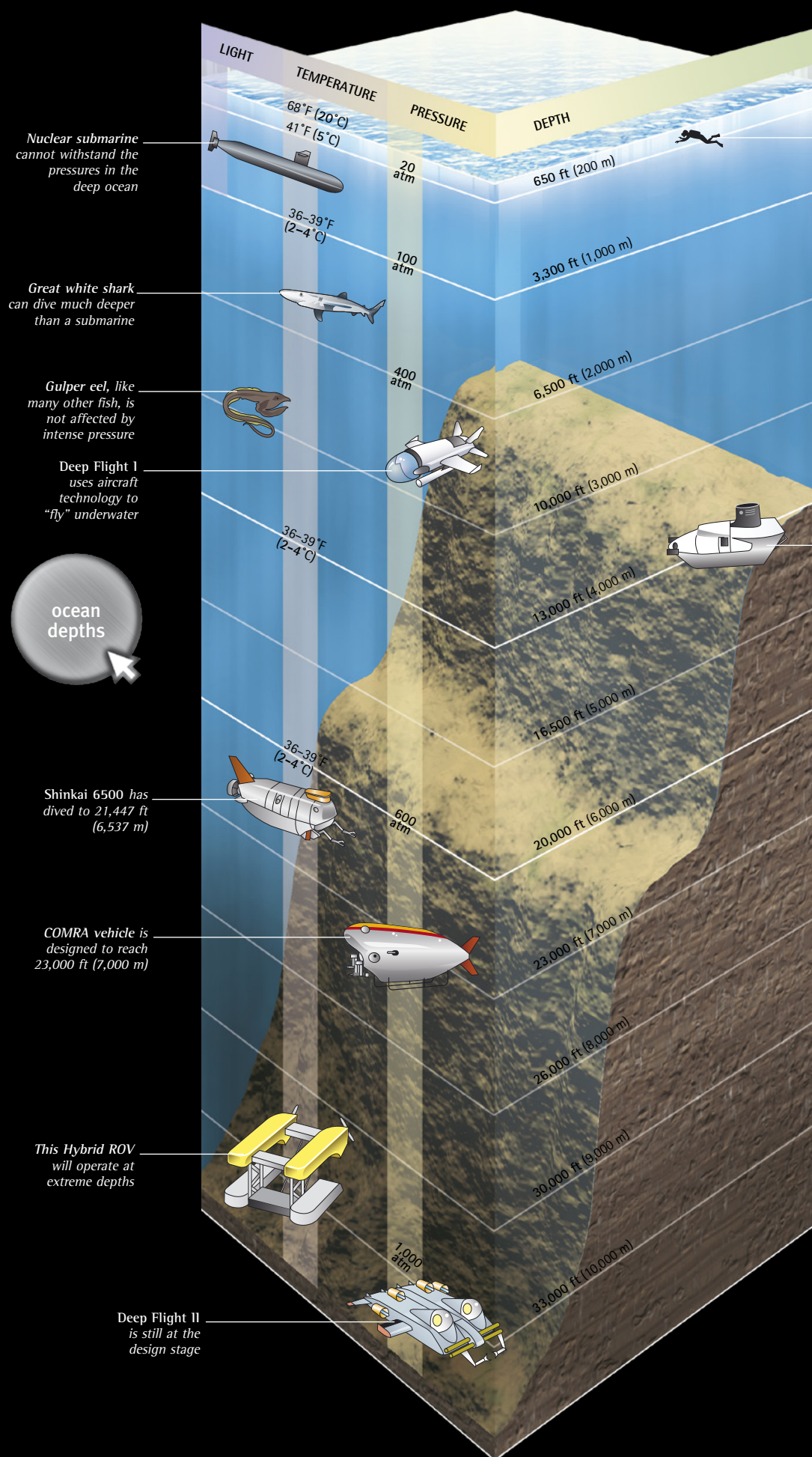




Scuba diver at a maximum depth of 50 m (164 ft)

◀ PROBING THE DEEP

Human divers cannot dive very deep without special pressure-proof suits. Pressurized submersibles can venture much deeper, but each has its limits. Remotely operated vehicles (ROVs) will soon be able to penetrate deep ocean trenches, and engineers are working on manned vehicles with the same capabilities.

Alvin has a depth limit of 14,746 ft (4,500 m)



▲ REMOTE CONTROL

A lot of deep-ocean exploration is now achieved using remotely operated vehicles (ROVs), with video links to the surface or to manned submersibles. For many applications—especially hazardous situations—ROVs such as the *Global Explorer* (shown above) are better than manned craft. They are ideal for investigating cavities such as inside wrecks and caves, or beneath the polar ice.